# Lantern VPN

2026-10-26

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# Accounts

How Lantern Pro accounts work: creating an account, signing in, managing devices, and keeping access to your subscription.

## Create a Lantern Pro Account

> [!NOTE] Accounts are only for Lantern Pro. The free version of Lantern does not use an account.

What you will need depends on your platform:

| Platform | Payment Method | Plans Available | When You Add a |
|---|---|---|---|
| iOS | Apple App Store | 1-month, 1-year | After purchase ( |
| Android (Google Play) | Google Play | 1-month, 1-year | After purchase ( |
| Android (sideloaded) | Card (Stripe) or Alipay | 1-month, 1-year, 2-year | Before purchase |
| Desktop (Windows, macOS, Linux) | Card (Stripe) or Alipay | 1-month, 1-year, 2-year | Before purchase |

All card purchases are auto-renewing subscriptions. Alipay purchases are one-time payments.

### Choose a Plan

1. Select the `Upgrade to Pro` banner on the home screen, or open the menu and choose the upgrade option
2. Select a plan from the Plans screen
3. On iOS and Google Play, the store payment prompt appears now, and you add your email after paying. On desktop and sideloaded Android, you create your account first and pay after.

### Add Your Email

On the `Add Your Email` screen you can:

- **Enter an email address** - a 6-digit confirmation code is sent to your email. Enter it on the `Confirm Email` screen. If it does not arrive, check spam and select `Resend Email`. See also Not Receiving Emails from Lantern.
- **Continue with Google** or **Continue with Apple** - your account is created instantly from your Google or Apple identity. No confirmation code or password is needed. Remember which one you used: you must sign in the same way later.

- **Continue without Email** (iOS and Google Play only) - your subscription works on this device only. A valid email address is required to use your subscription on other devices. You can add an email later; see Add an Email to an Account Created Without One.

If you see a `Create Account Error` saying the sign-up went wrong, the email address may already have an account. Choose `Sign In` instead.

#### Pay (desktop and sideloaded Android)

On the `Choose Payment Method` screen, pick card or Alipay. Card payments are processed by Stripe, and Alipay opens a payment page in your browser.

If you have paid but your subscription does not show as active right away, wait a few hours and restart Lantern. If it still does not show, see I paid but my account is not showing Pro.

#### Create a Password (email sign-up only)

Passwords must contain at least 8 characters, including an uppercase letter, a lowercase letter, a number, and a special character. After setting your password, your account is ready and Lantern Pro is active.

## Sign In to Lantern

1. Select `Sign in` from the menu on the home screen
2. On the `Sign In to Lantern` screen, choose the same method you signed up with:
   - **Email**: enter your email, select `Sign in with Email`, then enter your password
   - **Continue with Google** or **Continue with Apple**

   [!TIP] If you signed up with Google or Apple, you do not have a Lantern password. Use the matching Google or Apple button to sign in, or select `Forgot your password?` to set a password for the first time. See Setting and Resetting Lantern Pro Password.

## Device Limit and Removing Devices

Lantern Pro works on up to 5 devices per account. If you sign in on a sixth device, the `Device Limit Reached` screen lists your linked devices. Select a device you no longer use, then select `Remove Device and Sign In` - sign-in continues automatically after the device is removed.

If you do not recognize a device in the list, it is usually an old phone or computer where you previously installed Lantern. Removing it does not affect your other devices.

## Change Your Account Email

1. Open the menu and go to `Account`
2. Select `Change Email` and confirm your password
3. Enter your new email address - a 6-digit confirmation code is sent to the new address
4. Enter the code on the `Confirm Email` screen

Your new email becomes your login email once verified.

## Restore Your Purchase on a New Device

1. Install Lantern and select the `Upgrade to Pro` banner
2. Select the 3-dot menu at the top right of the Plans screen
3. Select `Restore Purchase`
4. Sign in with your account email (or Google/Apple) - your Pro status is restored on this device

## Manage or Renew Your Subscription

Open the menu and go to `Account` to see your Lantern Pro email and your expiration or renewal date.

- **Purchased on iOS**: manage your subscription from your Apple ID account settings
- **Purchased on Google Play**: manage your subscription from your Google Play account settings
- **Purchased on desktop or sideloaded Android**: use the `Manage Subscription` option in Account settings

When a subscription expires, select `Renew Pro Subscription` to start a new purchase.

## Add an Email to an Account Created Without One

If you purchased on iOS or Google Play and chose `Continue without Email`, your subscription is tied to that device only. To use it elsewhere:

1. On the original device, open the menu and select `Account`
2. On the `Update Pro Account` prompt, select `Add Email`
3. Enter your email, confirm it with the 6-digit code, and create a password

You can then sign in on your other devices.

## Legacy Pro Users: Set Your Password

If you had Lantern Pro before version 9, you need to set a password once in the new app.

**On your existing device:** open the menu and select `Account`. On the `Set Account Password` prompt, select `Set Password`, confirm your email with the verification code, and create a password.

**On a new device:** go to the sign-in screen, enter your Pro email, select `Forgot your password?`, and set a password through the email verification flow. Then sign in with your new password.

## Log Out of Lantern

Open the menu, go to `Account`, and select `Logout`. Logging out switches Lantern to the free version on that device; your subscription is unaffected and you can sign back in at any time.

## Common Account Issues

### Lantern asks me for a password, but I signed up with Google or Apple

Use the `Continue with Google` or `Continue with Apple` button on the sign-in screen instead of `Sign in with Email`. Alternatively, select `Forgot your password?` to set a password for the first time.

### I am not receiving the verification code

Check your spam or junk folder, then select `Resend Email` on the `Confirm Email` screen. Some email providers block our messages entirely; see Not Receiving Emails from Lantern.

### I paid but my account is not showing Pro

Payments can take time to be reflected. Wait a few hours, then restart Lantern. If your account still does not show Pro, contact support with your receipt; see Report a Payment Problem.

#### Purchase was not completed

This appears when a store payment was cancelled, the payment method failed, or the app closed during purchase. Check that your App Store or Play Store payment method is valid, then try again from the Plans screen.

# Downloads & Updates

## Download Lantern

### GitHub

All download files, including backups and beta releases, are available at: https://github.com/getlantern

### Website

Download our latest stable version from: https://lantern.io/download

### Email

Email provides a reliable and block resistant channel for distributing application downloads.

Send an email to any of the following email addresses to receive links to our newest stable release for every platform.

| use | addresses |
|---|---|
| generic | downloads@getlantern.org, download@getlantern.org |
| China | chinadownloads@getlantern.org, chinadownload@getlantern.org |
| Russia | russiadownloads@getlantern.org, russiadownload@getlantern.org |
| Iran | irandownloads@getlantern.org, irandownload@getlantern.org |

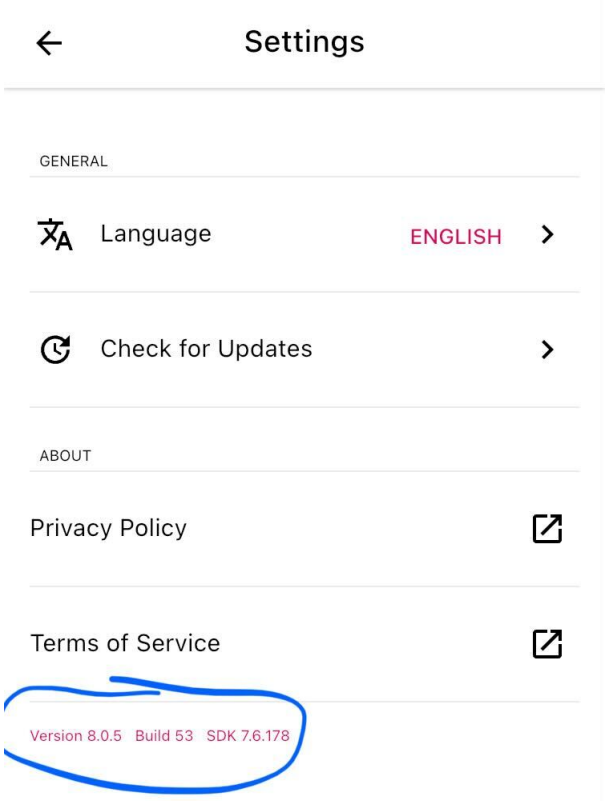
## Update Lantern

1. open Lantern
2. navigate to `Account`
3. select `Settings`
4. choose `Check for Updates`

If an update cannot be completed in the application, follow the Download Lantern instructions to update.

**Check Version**

1. open Lantern
2. navigate to `Account`
3. select `Settings`
4. version number is listed on bottom of the screen




Check our release notes to see which version is newest, and always ensure you're updated to the latest version to access the latest protocols and most

effective proxies.

# Features

## Split Tunneling

Split tunneling specifies which apps and websites use proxies, and which connect directly. Because routing a VPN connection through a proxy adds some latency and speed reduction, the fastest connection will only proxy traffic that requires it. Blocked or restricted content can be routed through proxies, while the remaining traffic connects directly for the fastest speeds possible.

Try enabling split tunneling if you are noticing slower than ideal overall network speeds, and experiment with which apps or sites benefit the most!

see also: https://lantern.io/faq#privacy-4

# Free Tier Data Cap

## How much data does the free tier give me?

Free users get **244 MB of data per day** (about 256 MB in decimal terms). The cap resets every 24 hours and is the same on Windows, macOS, Android, and iOS.

## What happens when I hit the cap?

Lantern does not disconnect you. Your download speed is reduced to about 128 Kbit/s until the next daily reset. Uploads are limited to about 5 Mbit/s, which is high enough that sending requests still works normally. You will receive notifications at 50%, 80%, and 100% of your daily usage, and the home screen shows when the cap has been reached along with the reset time.

## Are there places where the free tier has no cap?

Yes. Free users in **Iran, Russia, and Belarus** have unlimited data. We are able to offer this because grant funding supports uncensored access

in those locations, and because international sanctions and payment-processor restrictions make Pro subscriptions difficult or impossible to purchase there.

### How do I remove the cap everywhere else?

Lantern Pro removes the daily limit worldwide.

## Installation

### Install Lantern on Desktop

Download Lantern for Windows, MacOS, or Linux directly from GitHub.

Beta testers and early adopters of new releases may see a precautionary malware warning when installing. This message can be safely ignored.

### Install Lantern on iOS

Downloading Lantern for iOS requires an AppleID based in an unrestricted country or region. If you currently have a valid payment method with a billing address in an unrestricted location, you may simply follow Apple instructions for updating your AppleID location to that country or region. Otherwise, it will be necessary to create an alternate AppleID:

1. Setup New AppleID in Unrestricted Country or Region
2. Sign out of iCloud (Data and funds may not transfer to the new account.)
3. Create a new account
4. Verify with unlinked email
5. Choose an unrestricted country

For more details, see this article from CNET.

> [!NOTE] An address is required for “billing details,” but you may choose any public address (such as a library) in your new Country or Region to proceed. Payment method is not required.

## Install Lantern on Android

### Google Play Store

Download Lantern from the Google Play Store for easiest installation.

### Sideloading

Users who cannot access Lantern from an app store may manually install a Lantern APK.

On Android 14:

1. Open `Settings` from the app launcher
2. Select `Apps`
3. Select `Special app access`
4. Select `Install unknown apps`, and select which apps (file manager or browser) you would like to allow to install APK files to your device by toggling the `Allow from this source` option.
5. Download the Lantern for Android APK from GitHub
6. Once downloaded, open the APK file from the downloads folder in your web browser, or from the File Manager, and select `Install`
7. If successful, you will be prompted with a confirmation message when the app has finished installing

   [!NOTE] If using a web browser or Chrome to install Lantern, you will be prompted with a message saying that the file you are about to download might be harmful. This warning is always shown when downloading an APK file and can be safely ignored.

# Lantern Pro

## Redeeming Lantern Pro License/Activation Codes

1. On a device not currently logged in, select the “Upgrade to Pro” button from the home screen
2. Select the 3-dot menu icon on the top right of the screen
3. Select the “Lantern Pro License” option

4. Enter an email, or select the “Continue with Google” or “Continue with Apple” option if applicable **(Note: If you have a pro account, simply go back to the menu and select sign in instead)**
5. Enter the confirmation code sent to your email **(Does not apply to “Continue with Google” or “Continue with Apple” options)**
6. Copy and paste the 25-digit Lantern Pro License code into the text box, and select “Activate Lantern Pro”

## Setting and Resetting Lantern Pro Password

With version 9, we have introduced a new login option that allows users to authorize devices using their email and a password of their choice. To set a password, follow the instructions below:

1. Select “Sign in” from the menu on the home screen
2. Enter your Lantern Pro email address
3. Select “Forgot Password”
4. Follow the instructions on the screen and in your email inbox
5. Log in to Lantern Pro using the same Lantern Pro email address and new password

## Report a Payment Problem

If a payment went through but your account is not showing Pro, or you were charged unexpectedly, contact us through the in-app issue report (Submit an Issue Report) or by email to support@lantern.io. Including all of the following helps us find your payment quickly:

- How you paid: card, Alipay, Apple App Store, or Google Play
- The email address you used at purchase (or with Google/Apple sign-up, that account’s email)
- The approximate date of the purchase
- The order or transaction ID from your receipt

  [!NOTE] Alipay payment records are only available to us for 21 days after purchase, so please report Alipay payment problems as soon as possible.

## Request a Refund

Our refund policy is section 4.4 of our Terms of Service. If something is not working, contact support first so we can try to fix the problem.

- **Purchased with card or Alipay:** email support@lantern.io with your receipt and the details listed in Report a Payment Problem
- **Purchased through the Apple App Store:** Apple processes these payments, so refunds are requested from Apple at https://reportaproblem.apple.com
- **Purchased through Google Play:** contact support@lantern.io with your Google Play order number (starts with GPA)

# Security

## Recommended Security Resources

Your security needs may be different than others, depending on your location, your needs, and your particular threat model. Lantern recommends the following sources for understanding and identifying your particular security needs.

- Consumer Reports | Security Planner (https://securityplanner.consumerreports.org/)
- Miaan Digital Security Helpdesk | Assistance (https://miaan.org/projects/miaan-digital-security-helpdesk/)

## Right to be Forgotten - Account Deletion

If you would like to remove all of your personal information from our user database, please follow the following steps:

> [!WARNING] Account deletion is permanent. You will lose access on all devices, and any remaining Pro subscription time will be forfeited without a refund.

**Legacy Users (version 8.3.7 or earlier)** Send and email with your request to support@lantern.io and we will manually remove your information from our system.

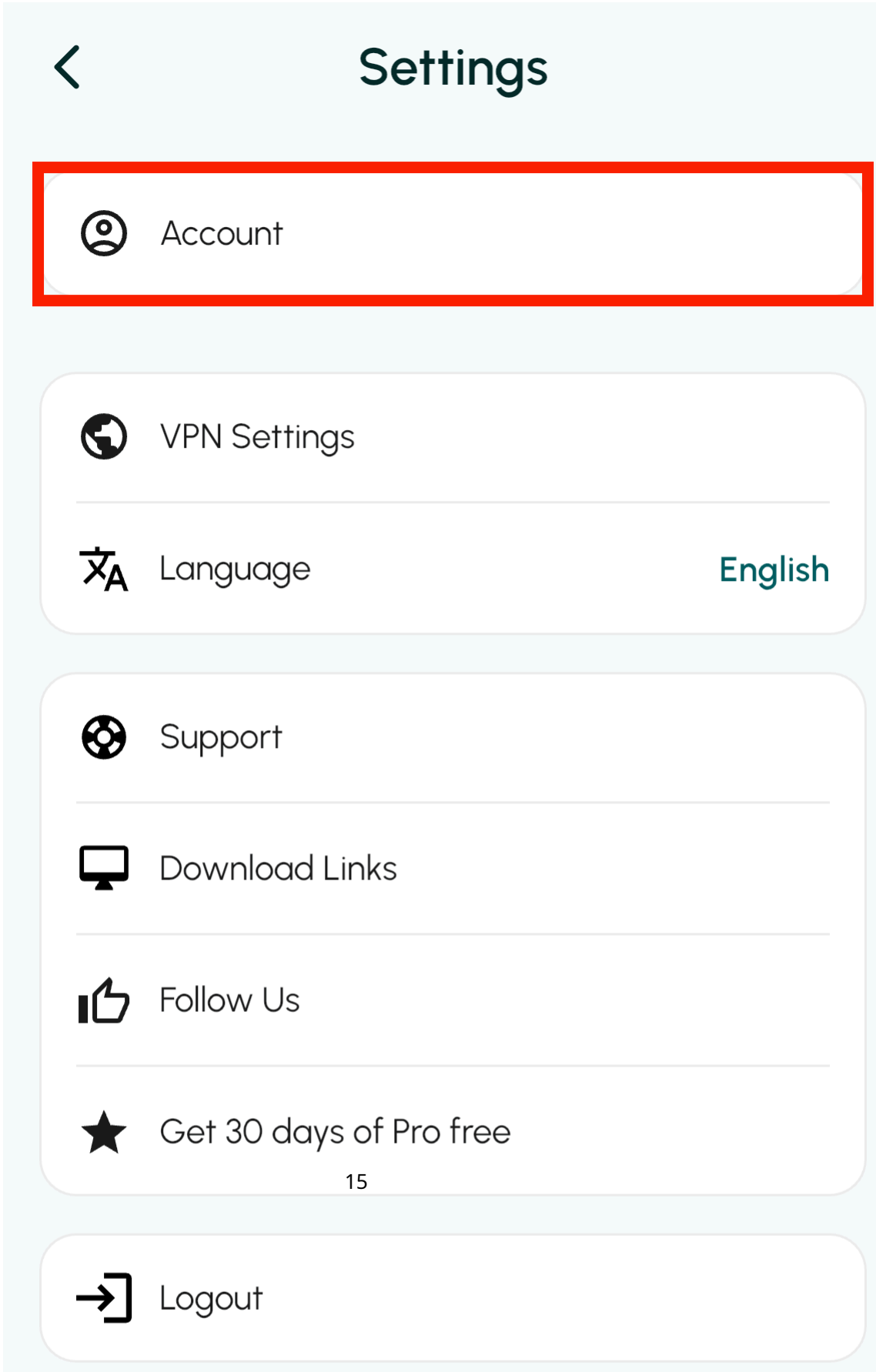
#### Lantern VPN Users (version 9.0.1 or later)

1. Open the main menu and navigate to the `Account` section.

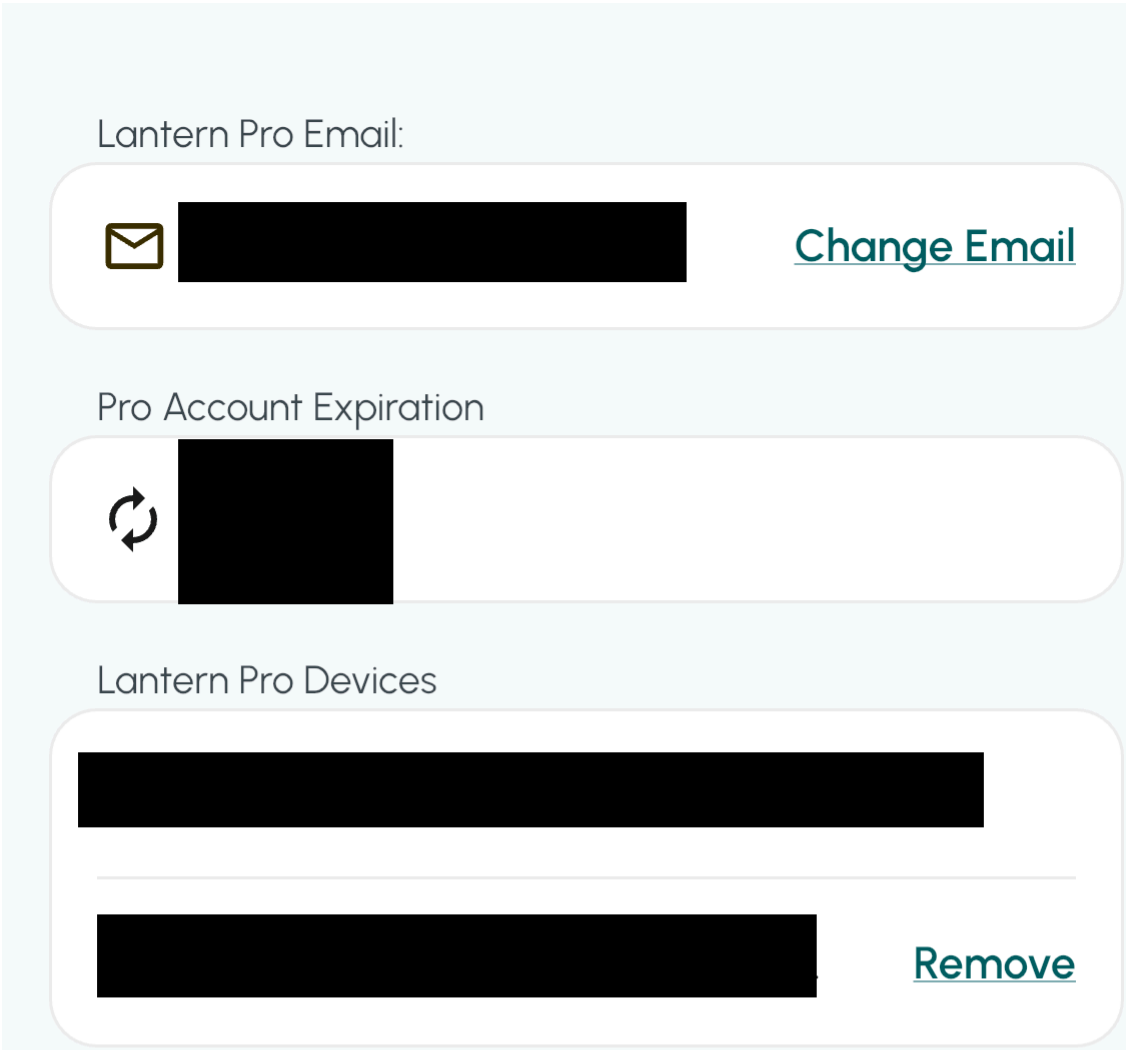


LANTERN PRO




Settings
Account
VPN Settings
Language
English
Support
Download Links
Follow Us
Get 30 days of Pro free
Logout

1. Select `Delete Account` at the bottom of the screen, enter your Lantern Pro password, and select `Confirm Deletion`


Lantern Pro Email:
[redacted]
Change Email
Pro Account Expiration
[redacted]
Lantern Pro Devices
[redacted]
[redacted]
Remove

If you signed up with Google or Apple, select `Verify with Google` or `Verify with Apple` instead of entering a password, and use the same account you signed up with.

## Verify a File Download

How to validate that a client application file is authentic, even if downloaded through an untrusted network.

Hash functions can be used to create a unique digital signature – a *hash* – for any file. Lantern captures this *hash* when our application is compiled and publishes them on GitHub: `lantern-binaries`. Users can run the same hash function (`SHA256`) on downloaded copies to assure they are an exact match, proving the file to be an authentic and unaltered copy of the original.

Most operating systems have built-in hash functions. Follow the steps below for your operating system to generate the hash for a file.

> [!IMPORTANT] Make sure to replace `C:\file\path\my_file.exe` or `/path/to/my_file` with the actual path to the file.

### MacOS or Linux

From your preferred terminal application, run the following command:

```
openssl dgst -sha256 /path/to/my_file
```

### Windows

#### Command Prompt

1. Press `Windows+R` to open the Run box
2. Type `cmd` and click OK.
3. The Command Prompt window will open.
4. Run the following command:

   ```
   certutil -hashfile C:\file\path\my_file.exe SHA256
   ```

   #### Power Shell

   (a) Press `Windows+R` to open the Run box
   (b) Type `powershell` and click OK.
   (c) The Windows PowerShell window will open.
   (d) Run the following command: `console Get-FileHash C:\file\path\my_file.exe -Algorithm SHA256`

# Troubleshooting

## Not Receiving Emails from Lantern

This applies to any email Lantern sends: confirmation and verification codes, password resets, device linking codes, receipts, and download links.

Some email providers, especially Chinese consumer providers, block or delay messages from services hosted outside mainland China. Known affected domains include `qq.com`, `163.com`, `126.com`, `yeah.net`, `sina.com`, `sina.cn`, `aliyun.com`, `sohu.com`, `tom.com`, `21cn.com`, and `foxmail.com`.

If an email does not arrive:

1. Check your spam or junk folder
2. Use the resend option on the screen you are on (for example `Resend Email` on the `Confirm Email` screen)
3. If it still does not arrive and you use one of the providers above, change your account email to a known reliable provider:

- Outlook
- iCloud Mail
- Yahoo Mail
- Gmail
- Proton Mail - a free, nonprofit, privacy focused email provider. In China, Proton mail require a VPN.

## Reset Proxy Configuration

### Windows

Some Windows applications (like WhatsApp) may have custom proxy rules that do not route through Lantern proxies. This can be solved most easily by using the web version of the application, because Lantern proxies browser traffic by default. Another option is to reset any app-specific proxy rules:

1. Open Command Prompt or PowerShell (right click to “Run as administrator”)
2. Run the command `netsh winhttp reset proxy`

3. Restart your computer
4. Open Lantern and connect

## Install Websites as Apps (desktop)

### Firefox

1. Install the Progressive Web Apps for Firefox extension
2. Navigate to the desired site and click the `Install This Web App` button found in the URL bar after extension is installed
3. Follow installation Prompts Official documentation can be found here

### Chrome

1. Navigate to the desired site, and click the `More` menu on the top right of the browser
2. Select `Cast, save, and share`, then `Install page as app`
3. Follow the installation prompts Official documentation can be found here

### Microsoft Edge

1. If Microsoft Edge detects that the site is eligible to be installed as an app, there will be an `App Available` icon displayed on the right side of the URL bar.
2. Click the icon, and select `Install`
3. Follow installation prompts Official documentation can be found here

### Safari (macOS Sonoma 14 or later)

1. Navigate to the desired site
2. Click the `Share` button on the Safari Toolbar, and select `Add to Dock`
3. Follow installer prompts Official documentation can be found here

## Submit an Issue Report

### Application Issue Report

Submit an issue report from the app for best diagnostics: https://lantern.io/report-issue

If the link above does not work, follow the steps below to navigate to the issue submission page:

**Desktop**

1. go to Support
2. select Report an Issue
3. choose issue type
4. include additional details
5. send report

**Android**

1. go to Account
2. select Support
3. select Report Issue
4. choose issue type
5. include additional details
6. hit Send Report

**Other Issue Report Methods**

**Portal** If an application issue report cannot be submitted, our portal may be used: https://support.lantern.io

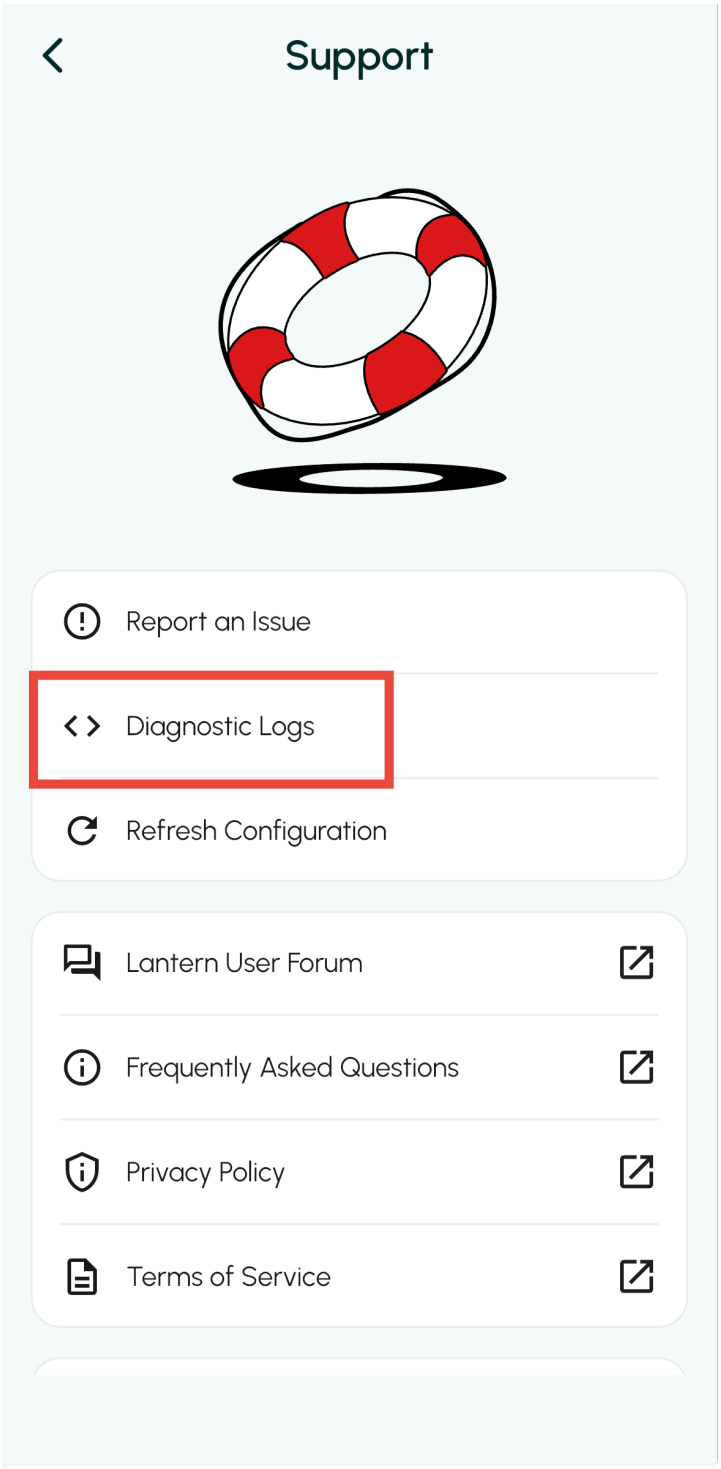
**Email** If other methods are not possible, email is a reliable fallback. Any message to support@lantern.io will automatically be converted into a helpdesk ticket.

**Log Retrieval**

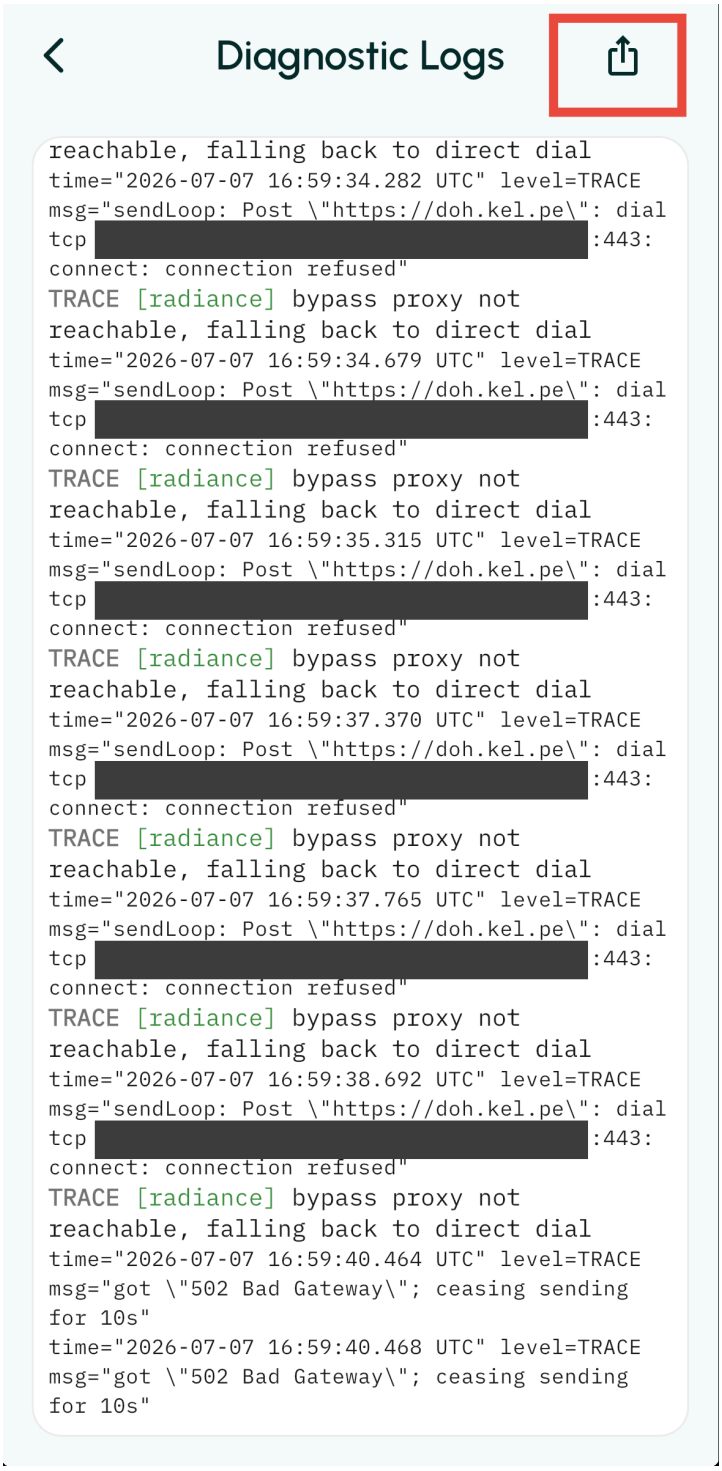
If you can't submit an issue report from within the app, you can still share your logs with support.

**Share logs from the app (all platforms)** The quickest way to send your logs is directly from the app. This works on desktop and mobile, including iOS and Android:

1. Open Lantern and go to **Support**.
2. Tap **Diagnostic Logs**.


Support
Report an Issue
Diagnostic Logs
Refresh Configuration
Lantern User Forum
Frequently Asked Questions
Privacy Policy
Terms of Service

1. On the Diagnostic Logs screen, tap the **Share** icon in the top-right corner.


Diagnostic Logs
reachable, falling back to direct dial
time="2026-07-07 16:59:34.282 UTC" level=TRACE
msg="sendLoop: Post \"https://doh.kel.pe\": dial
tcp [redacted]:443:
connect: connection refused"
TRACE [radiance] bypass proxy not
reachable, falling back to direct dial
time="2026-07-07 16:59:34.679 UTC" level=TRACE
msg="sendLoop: Post \"https://doh.kel.pe\": dial
tcp [redacted]:443:
connect: connection refused"
TRACE [radiance] bypass proxy not
reachable, falling back to direct dial
time="2026-07-07 16:59:35.315 UTC" level=TRACE
msg="sendLoop: Post \"https://doh.kel.pe\": dial
tcp [redacted]:443:
connect: connection refused"
TRACE [radiance] bypass proxy not
reachable, falling back to direct dial
time="2026-07-07 16:59:37.370 UTC" level=TRACE
msg="sendLoop: Post \"https://doh.kel.pe\": dial
tcp [redacted]:443:
connect: connection refused"
TRACE [radiance] bypass proxy not
reachable, falling back to direct dial
time="2026-07-07 16:59:37.765 UTC" level=TRACE
msg="sendLoop: Post \"https://doh.kel.pe\": dial
tcp [redacted]:443:
connect: connection refused"
TRACE [radiance] bypass proxy not
reachable, falling back to direct dial
time="2026-07-07 16:59:38.692 UTC" level=TRACE
msg="sendLoop: Post \"https://doh.kel.pe\": dial
tcp [redacted]:443:
connect: connection refused"
TRACE [radiance] bypass proxy not
reachable, falling back to direct dial
time="2026-07-07 16:59:40.464 UTC" level=TRACE
msg="got \"502 Bad Gateway\"; ceasing sending
for 10s"
time="2026-07-07 16:59:40.468 UTC" level=TRACE
msg="got \"502 Bad Gateway\"; ceasing sending
for 10s"

1. Choose how to send the logs (for example, email them to support@lantern.io) and send.

**Retrieve the log file manually (desktop)** If you'd rather attach the log file yourself, Version 9 stores logs in a new location, so use the section that matches your version.

**Version 9 (current)**

- **Windows:** Open File Explorer and go to `C:\Users\Public\Lantern\logs`
- **macOS:** Open Terminal, run `open /Users/Shared/Lantern/Logs`
- **Linux:** Open Terminal, run `xdg-open ~/.local/share/org.getlantern.lantern/logs`

Select the newest `lantern.log` file and attach it to an email to support@lantern.io.

**Advanced: VPN service log (Windows and Linux only)**

On Windows and Linux, Lantern runs a separate background service that handles the VPN connection itself, and it keeps its own log apart from the main app. Support may ask for this log to diagnose connection or "no traffic" problems.

- **Windows:** Open File Explorer, paste `C:\ProgramData\Lantern` into the address bar, and press Enter (this folder is hidden by default)
- **Linux:** Open Terminal, run `xdg-open /var/log/lantern`

Attach the newest `lantern.log` from that folder in addition to the log above.

**Legacy (before Version 9)**

- **Windows:** In File Explorer, enable hidden items (View menu), then go to `C:\Users\<username>\AppData\Roaming\Lantern\Logs`
- **macOS:** Open Terminal, run `open ~/Library/Logs/Lantern`
- **Linux:** Open Terminal, run `xdg-open ~/.lantern/logs`

Select the newest `lantern.log` file and send it to support@lantern.io.

**iOS and Android** Device security settings do not permit direct access to the log file. Use **Share logs from the app** above to send your logs.

**Advanced Diagnostics**

Problems which are difficult to diagnose with logs may require more advanced tools like packet capture.

https://www.wireshark.org/download.html

> [!WARNING] Packet capture will expose raw data for *all* traffic during the period of recording. We recommend this method only for advanced users who are able to ensure that no personal data is included in the packet capture.
>
> While Lantern ensures that all data submitted to our portal is kept secure and fully deleted shortly after it is closed, it's always advisable to limit the recording and transmission of personally identifying information.